

Skiping Rope

C:2

No. 1 from *Children's Album*, Book 2

Aram Khachaturian
(1903–78)

Allegro ♩ = 144

The musical score for 'Skiping Rope' is written for piano. It begins with a treble and bass clef, a key signature of two sharps (D major), and a 4/4 time signature. The tempo is marked 'Allegro' with a quarter note equal to 144 beats per minute. The score is divided into four systems of two staves each. The first system (measures 1-6) starts with a forte (f) dynamic. The second system (measures 7-12) begins with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The third system (measures 13-18) includes a crescendo (cresc.) marking and returns to forte (f). The fourth system (measures 19) ends with a ritardando (rit.) marking. The melody in the right hand consists of eighth and quarter notes, often beamed together. The left hand provides a simple accompaniment of quarter and eighth notes. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-5. Articulation marks like slurs and accents are used throughout.

This musical picture of a skipping rope in action is selected from Khachaturian's *Children's Album* (Детский альбом Detskii al'bom), of which the first volume appeared in 1946 and the second in 1964. The opening melody occurs three times. Its first and third statements (bb. 1 and 17) are virtually identical, but the middle one (b. 9) is quieter, in the dominant key, and has a legato, chromatic accompaniment in the left hand. The left-hand *a* on the fourth beat of b. 16 belongs to the tune (compare the upbeat to b. 1) and so needs a little emphasis.

Aram Khachaturian studied at the Gnesin Institute, Moscow (1922–9) and then at the Moscow Conservatory (1929–36). He later taught at both institutions. His colourful, pictorial compositions include three symphonies, three concertos, film music and ballets, notably *Spartacus*, which has become his most famous work.

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